



**JABATAN PEMBANGUNAN KEMAHIRAN
KEMENTERIAN SUMBER MANUSIA
ARAS 7 & 8 BLOK D4, KOMPLEKS D
PUSAT PENTADBIRAN KERAJAAN PERSEKUTUAN
62530 PUTRAJAYA**

KERTAS PENERANGAN (*INFORMATION SHEET*)

KOD DAN NAMA PROGRAM / <i>PROGRAM'S CODE AND NAME</i>	Z-009-1:2015 CORE ABILITIES	
TAHAP / LEVEL	1 (ONE)	
NO. DAN TAJUK KEBOLEHAN TERAS / <i>CORE ABILITY NO. AND TITLE</i>	CA02 PERSONAL BEHAVIOUR SKILL	
NO. DAN PENYATAAN KEBOLEHAN / <i>ABILITY NO. AND STATEMENT</i>	02.01 DEMONSTRATE HONESTY AND INTEGRITY 02.02 ADOPT WORK PUNCTUALITY 02.03 DEMONSTRATE TEAM COOPERATION	
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TAJUK/TITLE : TEAM COOPERATION

TUJUAN/PURPOSE :

This Information Sheet is intended to describe on demonstrate team cooperation. The person who is competent in this Module shall be able to demonstrate good attitudes, values and behaviours in the working environment.

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PENERANGAN/INFORMATION :

1 Teams In The Workplace

- 1.1 Most of us are already familiar with the idea of a team especially if we've ever participated in or watched any type of organized sports activity. Work teams are formal groups, made up of interdependent individuals responsible for attaining a goal. Thus all work teams are groups but only formal groups can be work teams.
- 1.2 Teams can vary in their purpose or goal. The duration of a team can be either permanent or temporary. Functional department teams and others that are part of the organization's formal structure is a type of permanent team. Temporary teams include task forces, project teams, problem-solving teams and any other types of short term teams created to develop, analyze or study a business or work-related issue.
- 1.3 Team membership can either be functional or cross-functional. Functional teams are composed of a manager and his or her subordinates from a particular functional area. Functional team are often involved in efforts to improve work activities or solve specific problems within that particular area only. Within this functional team, issues such as authority, decision-making, leadership and interaction are relatively simple and clear.
- 1.4 The cross-functional team has members from various functional areas, with different areas of expertise and from different organizational levels, and often formed to tackle issues which affect the whole organization. For example, the team could involve members from Production, Marketing, Accounts, Research & Development, CEO's office etc. The team is often led by a facilitator rather than a manager, with leaders appointed for different workgroups within the team. Decisions are much more consensus-based.
- 1.5 Teams can either be supervised or self-managed. A supervised team will be under the direction of a manager who's responsible for guiding the team in

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setting goals, in performing the necessary work activities and evaluating performance.

- 1.6 However, the self-directed or self-managed team is increasingly commonly used in companies. A Self-directed or Self-managed team is a formal team of employees who operate without a manager for a complete work process or segment the deliver a product or service to an internal or external customer. The self-managed team is responsible for getting the work done and managing themselves.

2 Concept Of Teamwork

- 2.1 Good teams enable each member to be more than they would be as just individuals. This is because Team Spirit means members demand a lot from each other, go extra lengths to support each other, have high motivation to achieve their joint vision, and enjoy high morale.
- 2.2 Work teams are critical for companies because they allow for better and faster decisions to be made by those who are close to the issue, and free up managers to focus on strategic and longer term matters.
- 2.3 The use of diverse and cross-functional teams should result in more innovative ideas and better decisions than might arise if individuals operate alone. This is due to the sharing of different experiences and knowledge and the use of different perspectives to consider the facts.
- 2.4 Some of the traits of Effective Teams are
 - i) A shared sense of purpose. All team members are clear on what their team's vision and goals are, from the big picture, down to the milestones which need to be achieved along the way.
 - ii) Clear roles. Team members know what is expected of each member, there's accountability and no unnecessary duplication or "dead wood".
 - iii) Defined team process. Team members not only know why and what they will achieve, they also know how they will go about achieving it.

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- iv) Strong relationships. Members of effective teams have good rapport with one another, and are kind and caring towards one another.
- v) Effective interactions between team members and with the manager. This means communication is open and honest, feedback is frequent and constructive and there is timely follow-through action.

2.5 Although it is mainly the role of the team leader or manager to ensure that their team embodies these traits, he/she cannot succeed unless all team members also appreciate the importance of embracing these team ideals.

2.6 Some of the typical obstacles which detract from the effectiveness of a team are:

- i) The team is too big. The most effective teams are smaller rather than bigger, avoiding "dead wood" and duplications in their structure.
- ii) The team members are not aligned on vision, goals or strategy, either because they are poorly informed, or they have not bought into these elements.
- iii) Poor, unhealthy interaction between members. This may happen because team members do not really feel they belong to the team, and are functioning like a collection of strangers, or worse still, competitors, rather than partners.
- iv) The team leader micro-manages and fails to delegate to, and empower, team members.
- v) Team members are not disciplined, accountable and committed. When one or two members consistently under-deliver, and these "weak links" are not reprimanded for it, this affects the morale of the whole team.

3 Types Of Roles In Teams

3.1 At the simplest level, the roles in the team can be divided into Team Leader and Team Member.

3.2 The role of the Team Leader is

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- i) Setting the team's objectives, ensuring these are clear to the team.
- ii) Owning the team's strategy and knowing when to adapt.
- iii) Assigning roles to team members according to their strengths.
- iv) Obtaining and organizing the resources required to achieve the objectives.
- v) Motivating team members to achieve the objectives. Ensuring high team morale.
- vi) Monitoring the team's performance against objectives and taking corrective actions.
- vii) Keep improving performance by developing self and team members. Learn from failure.
- viii) Promote the team and take responsibility for them.

3.3 The role of the Team Members are

- i) Supporting the Team Leader in exercising their role, including feedback and suggestions.
- ii) Supplying ideas and expertise to the best of their abilities.
- iii) High quality implementation of strategy.
- iv) Total accountability for delivering their part of the project.
- v) Commitment to the team's goals.
- vi) Close cooperation and support for fellow team members.
- vii) Creating a healthy team culture and good rapport between members.

4 Information Sharing

- 4.1 Not surprisingly, effective teams are characterized by good communication. Members are able to convey messages between each other in a form that is readily and clearly understood. This includes nonverbal as well as spoken messages.
- 4.2 Members also take responsibility for the dissemination of relevant information to the parties that need it. They double check that their colleagues are in the know. Miscommunication or non-communication rarely happens in effective teams.

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4.3 The communication culture in high-performing teams is open. Members are able to quickly and efficiently share ideas and feelings directly and be assured that their points will be taken into consideration, without prejudgement. Due to this open atmosphere, they feel confident to suggest something creative or different.

4.4 Communication in high-performing teams is also characterized by frequent, kind and healthy feedback from team members and management. This helps to guide fellow team members and even the team leader, to correct any weaknesses, and ensure consistent high performance.

5 Basic Problem-Solving Steps And Process

5.1 Very often, teams are formed to solve a problem. As such, one of the most important skills all teams must have is problem-solving. The most basic, and perhaps most widely used, technique for problem-solving is brainstorming.

5.2 Brainstorming uses a face-to-face, interactive group to spontaneously suggest ideas for problem solution.” Brainstorming is perhaps the best-known decision aid; its primary role is to supply additional creative solutions. The brainstorming technique encourages group members to suggest alternatives regardless of their likelihood of being implemented. No critical comments of any kind are allowed until all suggestions have been listed. Members are encouraged to brainstorm possible solutions out loud, and freewheeling is welcomed. The more novel and unusual the idea, the better. The object of brainstorming is to promote freer, more flexible thinking and to enable group members to build on one another’s creativity.

5.3 The typical brainstorming session comprises:

- i) A warm-up wherein definitional issues are settled, including agreeing on the Problem Statement

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- ii) The freewheeling idea-generation stage. Brainstorming is an unrestrained flow of ideas in a group with all critical judgments suspended.
- iii) An evaluation of feasible ideas into Impossible, Unlikely and Possible. The shortlist can be finetuned further based on a deeper discussions.

6 Socio-Cultural Communication

- 5.1 The more diverse teams are, the more risk there is about miscommunication and misunderstandings around verbal and non verbal communication. This is because people from different backgrounds have different norms for verbal and non verbal communication.
- 5.2 For example, traditionally in Malaysia, it can be deemed disrespectful to criticize or disagree openly, and it may be deemed acceptable to give vague commitments. The more subtle communication used by persons from such a background may not be well-understood by those from more modern backgrounds. Conversely, the former may also feel upset by the directness and assertiveness of the communication by the latter.
- 5.3 In diverse teams, it becomes very important for the facilitator or team manager to set clear ground rules about communication upfront, specifically about:
 - i) Taking care of clarity of what is being said
 - ii) Directness (going straight to the point)
 - iii) Specificity of commitments
- 5.4 Team members should also make effort to be aware of their default styles, and adapt to the style required for the group.

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SOALAN/QUESTION :

1. What are the key traits of Effective Teams?

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2. What are the roles of the Team Leader?

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3. How do you run a good brainstorming session?

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